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Making sense of the world



THE WEEK

Junior

GO WILD

Discover how the World Wide Fund for Nature protects wildlife across the planet **p14**

WWF aims to...

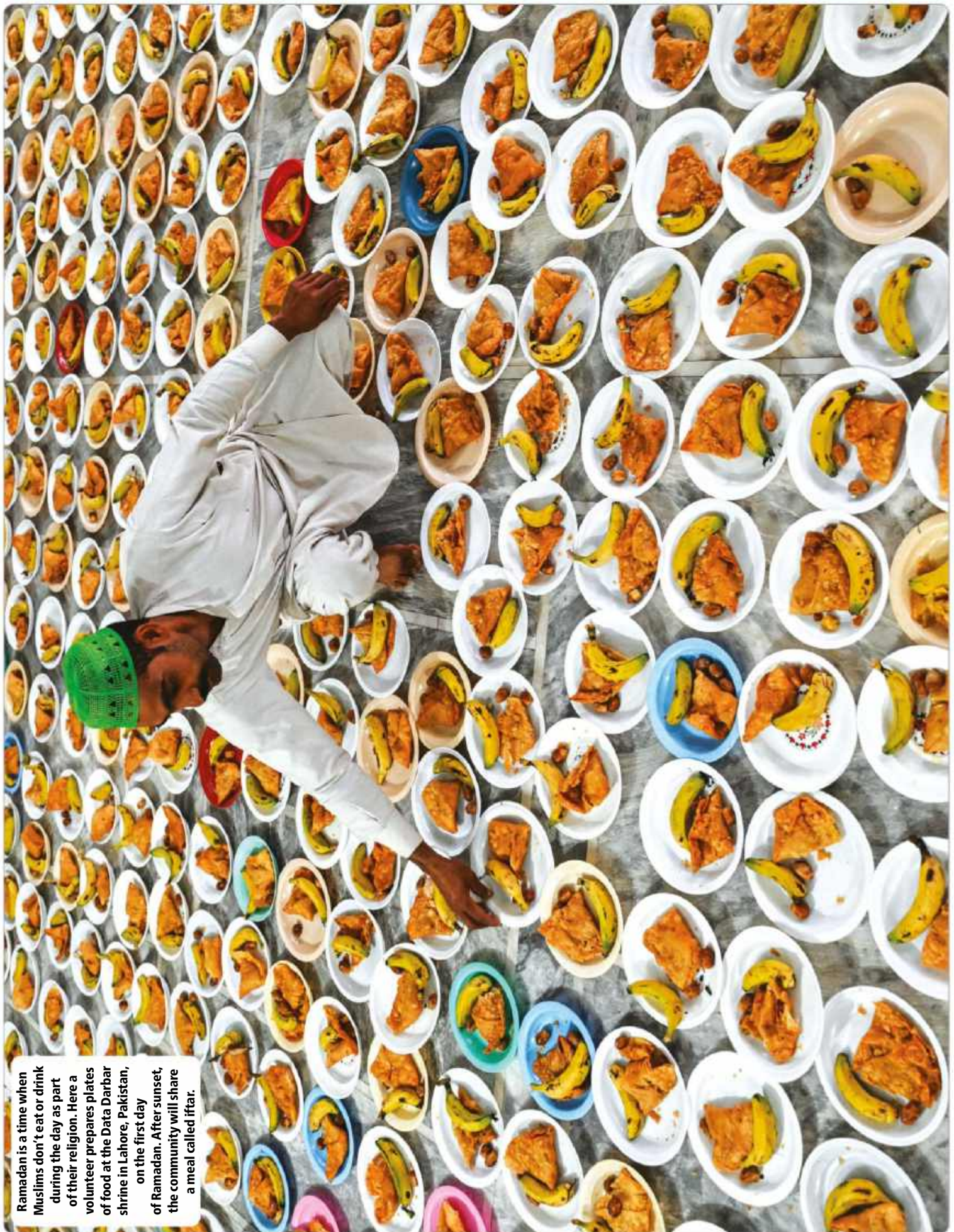
- Save endangered species and restore habitats.
- Reduce pollution and stop climate change.
- Help humans and nature live in harmony.
- Inspire people to take action.



A baby mountain gorilla in the Virunga Mountains, Rwanda, Africa.



The big picture



Ramadan is a time when Muslims don't eat or drink during the day as part of their religion. Here a volunteer prepares plates of food at the Data Darbar shrine in Lahore, Pakistan, on the first day of Ramadan. After sunset, the community will share a meal called iftar.



Something worth talking about

Lost for words? Try starting a conversation with one of these questions, inspired by stories in this magazine.



Scientists have released pictures of rare species photographed in Asia.

Which rare animal would you most like to spot?

Find out about the animals of the Annamite Mountains on page 12.



The National Gallery brings amazing paintings to local communities.

What is your favourite painting and why do you love it?

Read about some of the works on show on page 22.



Small things that make you happy can boost your mood.

What everyday activities put a smile on your face?

See some easy ways to create your own sparks of joy on page 21.



The big debate

Are audiobooks as good as reading? Page 10.

Editor's note

We know that protecting the planet is very important to our readers, so you'll enjoy the All About feature this week. I never realised that the World Wide Fund for Nature was started because a man named Victor Stolan read some articles in a newspaper about the threats facing many magnificent species in Africa. He was so shocked by what he read that he decided to do something about it. You can find out what happened on page 14. That is just one example of the power of reading, which we're celebrating this week in the run-up to World Book Day. On pages 24 and 25 you'll find five of the books you can buy for £1, as well as a book token. Do you prefer reading or listening to audiobooks? Join in the debate and have your say on page 10. I love that moment when I open a book to the first page and settle down to start reading. Where will this story take me? What worlds will I discover? It's actually one of my sparks of joy (page 21).



Vanessa Harriss
Editor

THIS WEEK IN HISTORY

28 February 2013

A pope resigns for first time since 1415



Pope Benedict XVI says goodbye.

The Pope is the leader of the Roman Catholic Church, the world's largest group of Christians. In February 2013, Pope Benedict XVI announced he was stepping down. Usually, a person is pope until he dies but Pope Benedict XVI said he was too old and unwell to stay on. It was the first time a pope had resigned in almost 600 years. Before becoming Pope in 2005, he was known as Cardinal Joseph Ratzinger, and at 78 he was the oldest newly elected pope since 1730. After he left, Pope Francis was chosen to replace him.

WORD OF THE WEEK

MAGICIAN

The words magic and magician (page 5) began with the word magus, used for a person in ancient Persia (now Iran) who was believed to have special powers and great wisdom. The plural of magus is "magi", the name given in the Bible to the wise men who visited the baby Jesus. Over time, the word magician came to describe someone whose powers included tricks and casting spells.



Don't just read
The Week Junior...

Listen to it!

This week, Bex, Joe and Eve are talking about World Book Day costumes.



Scan this code to take you straight there!



This week's big news

Andrew
Mountbatten-Windsor



The line of succession



Prince William (centre)
is heir to the throne.

The line of succession is the sequence in which members of the royal family become King or Queen. When Charles III dies or stands down, his oldest child, William (also known as the Prince of Wales), will become King. The next in line to the throne after William is his oldest child, George. After that is George's sister, Charlotte. Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor is currently eighth in line to the throne, so it is very unlikely he would ever become King. An Act of Parliament (a new law passed by Parliament) supported by the 15 countries where Charles is king would be needed to remove Mountbatten-Windsor from the line of succession.

King's brother arrested

On 19 February, the police arrested Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor, King Charles III's brother, on suspicion of misconduct in public office. Misconduct in public office is when a person does something seriously wrong while they are officially representing the UK. He is the first member of the British royal family to be arrested for 332 years.

Who is Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor?

He is one of the four children of Queen Elizabeth II, who died in 2022, and the brother of the King. He used to be known as Prince Andrew but, last year, King Charles removed this title because of reports about Mountbatten-Windsor's links to a convicted criminal. Earlier this year, Mountbatten-Windsor moved out of Royal Lodge, a mansion close to Windsor Castle in Berkshire, England. He moved into a home on the Sandringham Estate, which is owned by King Charles, in Norfolk, England.

What has happened?

On 19 February, Mountbatten-Windsor's 66th birthday, police arrived at the Sandringham Estate to arrest him and search his home. Officers also arrived

at Royal Lodge to search the property. Police drove Mountbatten-Windsor to a police station, where they questioned him. Eleven hours later, he was released but he is still under investigation. The police will give the evidence they have gathered on Mountbatten-Windsor to the Crown Prosecution Service, a Government department. Officials there will decide if he should be charged with committing crimes. This decision could take several weeks.

Why was he arrested?

The police said that Mountbatten-Windsor had been arrested for misconduct in public office. Earlier this year, the Thames Valley Police force said it was looking at reports that, while Mountbatten-Windsor was a UK trade envoy between 2001 and 2011, he sent important and secret information to a convicted criminal – the same criminal that he was linked to when he lost his title of prince. In his role as a trade envoy, Mountbatten-Windsor worked

for the Government to promote the interests of UK businesses abroad and had access to sensitive information. He did not earn a wage but his travel and some other costs were paid for by the UK Government.



King Charles issued
a statement.

What was the response?

On 19 February, King Charles released a statement about his brother's arrest. He said, "Let me state clearly: the law must take its course." The Government is now considering removing Mountbatten-Windsor from the line of succession (see panel). This has been backed by the government of Australia, where Charles is also King. The MP (Member of Parliament) Richard Burgon has called for an independent investigation into how much the royal family knew about Mountbatten-Windsor's links to the convicted criminal. On 24 February, MPs voted to release official documents about Mountbatten-Windsor getting the job of trade envoy in 2001.



Europe's noisiest countries revealed

A report has shown the European countries that are most affected by loud noise from aeroplanes, cars and trains. These unwanted sounds (known as noise pollution) affect around 112 million people.

According to the report, France has the most people suffering from noise pollution, with about 24 million affected. Germany is next with 22 million. Malta is the quietest country, with around 65,000 people affected. The UK was not included in the study. The report counts excessive noise as an average of more than 55 decibels (as loud as an electric toothbrush) – for the whole day-evening-night period – and above 50 decibels at night. Experts say that this level of long-term noise can affect people over time, including children. This is because human bodies react to noise like a nuisance, which can disturb sleep and make people feel stressed.

The report comes from the European Environment Agency, which is part of the European Union, a group of 27 countries that work and trade together. It said that although some plans are in place to reduce noise pollution, more action is needed. It said that walking or cycling more, lowering speed limits on roads, improving railway tracks and introducing quieter aircraft can all help tackle the problem.



France has high levels of noise pollution.



THEIR OWN WAY
Ukraine became an independent country in 1991.

A woman at a grave in a town near Kyiv.

Four years of war in Ukraine

On 24 February, Ukraine marked four years since Russia launched a full-scale invasion of the country. Ceremonies took place around Ukraine, and in Kyiv, the capital, to commemorate the anniversary. Leaders from countries, including the UK, Denmark, Norway and Sweden, joined the Kyiv ceremony to support Ukraine.

Since February 2022, the war has forced 3.7 million Ukrainians to leave their homes. Attacks have damaged more than 2.5 million homes and seriously damaged power plants across the country, leaving people without reliable heating and electricity. Nearly six million Ukrainians have fled the country to find safety.

It has been estimated that Russian forces have suffered 1.2 million casualties since February 2022, including 325,000 deaths. Ukrainian president

Volodymyr Zelensky recently said 55,000 Ukrainians had died during the four-year war.

In a statement, Zelensky said, "We will do everything to achieve peace and justice."

On the same day, several countries pledged support to Ukraine. The European Union (EU), a group of 27 countries that work together, promised to spend £79 billion on helping Ukraine this year. UK Prime

Minister Keir Starmer said the UK will "stand with Ukraine for as long as it takes".



EU leader Ursula von der Leyen with President Zelensky.



IT'S AN AMAZING WEEK FOR...

THIS LONELY MONKEY

A baby monkey at a zoo in Japan has gone viral online after he was given an orangutan toy when his mother abandoned him. Punch, a Japanese macaque, was seen bonding with his soft toy. Punch is now starting to make friends with other monkeys.



Punch



The magic show.

A YOUNG MAGICIAN

Nigerian magician Ibitoye Kingfahd has been awarded the Guinness World Record for the longest magic show by an individual. His show was 50 hours long and he performed more than 1,200 tricks. He first learned magic by watching YouTube videos and spent eight months preparing for his show.

DENNIS THE MENACE

The Royal Mint, which is the official maker of the UK's coins, has designed a special 50p coin to celebrate 75 years of Dennis the Menace in *Beano*. Dennis first appeared in the weekly comic on 17 March 1951. The colourful new coin features Dennis with his trusty sidekick, Gnasher the dog.



The Dennis 50p coin.



OFFICIAL SUPPORT

England passed its first law saying children with disabilities had the right to an education in 1893.



Pupils getting support in a lesson.

SEND across the UK



Education support varies across the UK.

Children with SEND get different support depending on where they are in the UK. In Scotland, a system called Additional Support Needs (ASN) includes children struggling to learn because of issues at home or in school. In Wales, there has been a system called Additional Learning Needs (ALN) since 2021. It uses Individual Development Plans (IDPs) to give children help all through school. Northern Ireland still uses the term SEND and its system is similar to England's. It has Statements of Special Educational Needs that outline pupils' needs and how schools will meet them.

Changes for SEND education

The Government has announced plans to change the system in England for school pupils with special educational needs and disabilities (SEND). The aim is to make sure more young people feel included in school. The Government said it will spend £4 billion over the next three years to help schools give extra learning support to pupils who need it.

What is SEND?

People with SEND can have trouble learning. This could be because of a physical disability, having different social or emotional needs, finding it very hard to concentrate or because they have challenges with reading, writing or understanding information.

In England, 1.7 million pupils – almost one in five – have SEND. Possible support includes things such as special lesson plans, extra help from a teacher or teaching assistant, or help with physical activities like getting around school. Some pupils with SEND go to specialist schools but others are taught in mainstream schools, where pupils without SEND go.

What has the Government announced?

Education Secretary Bridget Phillipson says that changes are needed to help mainstream schools give

children support that is suitable for them as early as possible. Some of the £4 billion will go towards hiring specialist teachers, along with speech and language experts. Teachers will also get training on how to design lessons to meet the needs of SEND pupils.

At the moment, if a young person needs more help than their school can provide, their family can apply for an Education, Health and Care Plan (EHCP). This guarantees them extra support but it can take a long time to get an EHCP. Under the new system, schools will work with parents to create Individual Support Plans (ISPs). These should be quicker to get and give support sooner – such as learning in smaller groups. By 2035, only children with the most severe or complicated educational needs will get EHCPs.

Why are the changes being made?

The number of children in England with EHCPs has doubled over the past 10 years. The Government says the changes will ensure there is enough support

for everyone. Under the new plan, the average secondary school would get about 160 days of dedicated specialist help each year. The aim is that people with SEND shouldn't wait as long for support, so they're less likely to fall behind in school. Prime Minister Keir Starmer, whose brother had SEND, said the plan would stop a "one size fits all" system that leaves some pupils struggling to keep up in lessons.



Bridget Phillipson

What was the response?

Many teachers' groups and charities welcomed the changes, saying the SEND system isn't working. However, some parents are worried that not all children will benefit. The charity Mencap called the plan "welcome news", but said the Government must make sure schools get all the money they are promised. NASUWT – an organisation representing teachers – said the funding sounds like a lot but is only a few thousand pounds extra per school. It said it was "ridiculous" to think this is enough to fix the SEND system.



The Old Bailey court, London.

Limit on court days lifted

On 24 February, David Lammy, the Government's Justice Secretary, said that from 1 April the cap (limit) on the number of days that Crown Courts in England and Wales can hear cases will be lifted. Crown Courts deal with the most serious crimes. The Ministry of Justice limits court days because of the cost but the Government is making more money available for extra days. Lammy hopes to reduce the list of people waiting to have cases heard in courts.



People at the festival.

York celebrates Viking past

From 16 to 22 February, Vikings descended on York, England, for the Jorvik Viking Festival. Jorvik was the name given to York by the Vikings when they invaded England and took over the city in AD866. During the festival, visitors watched displays of Viking sports including pillow fights using sacks of dead fish and the Vikings' version of football. There was also a feast and a recreation of a Viking battle. To end the festival there was a parade through the city.



A grey seal pup at Orford Ness.

Big rise in grey seal pups

At Orford Ness in Suffolk, England, rangers from the National Trust charity have welcomed the birth of 430 grey seal pups this winter. The number has increased by 88% since last winter. The colony started with 200 adult grey seals, who were sent to the site in 2021. Now, there are more than 800 adults. Ranger Tom Allen said it was "fantastic", but added that with much bigger numbers, and typically wintry weather, counting them can be difficult.



HEAVY RESPONSIBILITY
BAFTA awards are made of bronze metal – each one weighs 3.7 kilograms.

The makers of Boong with Paddington Bear.

BAFTAs celebrate the world of film

The BAFTA film awards took place in London on 22 February. The event celebrates the year's best films and actors, as well as the people who work behind the scenes to create films. BAFTA stands for British Academy of Film and Television Arts. The awards are voted for by members of the organisation.

The biggest star of the night was Paddington Bear, who got lots of cheers and hugs. The 1.2-metre tall bear from *Paddington: The Musical* is a performer called Arti Shah in a costume, which has its facial expressions changed by remote control. Paddington gave a speech before presenting an award, saying he was the first bear to do so, "and also the first presenter to get marmalade all over a BAFTA. Sorry about that."

Paddington presented the award for best children's and family film, which was won by *Boong*, the first Indian film to win this category. *Boong* tells the story of a boy who tries to bring his father home from Manipur, a state in north-east India where

different groups are fighting over land and religion. The director, Lakshmi Priya Devi, thanked BAFTA for "giving our very small film such big love".

Zootropolis 2 won best animated film. It tells the story of Judy Hopps, a rabbit police officer, and Nick Wilde, a fox, as they solve a mystery. It was released in November 2025 and has become one of the most successful animated films ever, earning more than £1.3 billion.

Other wins included *Avatar: Fire and Ash*, which won for best special visual effects. The biggest surprise was when Robert Aramayo from Hull, England, won the best actor award. He was up against lots of very famous Hollywood stars, including Leonardo DiCaprio and Timothée Chalamet.

The singers of *Huntr/x* from *KPop Demon Hunters* were at the show to sing the 2025 hit song *Golden*. It was the first time that Ejae, Audrey Nuna and Rei Ami had performed the song outside the US.



Huntr/x on stage at the BAFTAs.

THE WEEK'S SILLIEST HEADLINE

"Wandering dog joins skiing race at Winter Olympics" *The Independent*





Around the world



US Huge snowstorm hits east coast

A blizzard struck the east coast of the US, stretching from North Carolina to Maine. Hundreds of thousands of people were left without power as 83 centimetres of snow fell in some places. Several areas declared a state of emergency (when authorities give themselves special powers to deal with a crisis) to keep people safe in the bad weather.

Snow in New York.



Lima, Peru Temporary leader takes over

José María Balcázar has been named as Peru's ninth president in 10 years. He will only be in power for a few months until the country votes for a new president this summer. Balcázar was given the job after the last president, José Jerí, was accused of having secret meetings with Chinese businessmen.

José María Balcázar



Libreville, Gabon Social media ban

The government has banned social media, saying it spreads false information and is a risk to national security. The move follows growing unrest and strikes (when people refuse to work as a protest) in the country over pay and working conditions. Protesters, including teachers, had used social media to organise demonstrations.



No more social media.

Xalet del Catllaràs



Barcelona, Spain Home by Gaudí

An unusual white house in the mountains near Barcelona has been confirmed as a design by Antoni Gaudí, after research by experts. Gaudí was a famous architect (someone who designs buildings). The house, called Xalet del Catllaràs, was built between 1901 and 1908 to house workers from nearby coal mines. Gaudí died 100 years ago and is known for creating buildings that were inspired by shapes from nature.



Springs, South Africa Gold rush grips town

A small town called Springs has been taken over by gold hunters after news spread that the precious metal was found there. Someone discovered small gold nuggets in a field, so lots of people started digging there to see if they could find more. There were once lots of gold mines in Springs but they closed years ago. The government says digging in the area is illegal but the gold hunters say they need the money.

Hunting for gold.



ALAMY - VISITSWEDEN.COM - GETTY IMAGES - REX SHUTTERSTOCK



Sweden Island giveaway

The tourism organisation Visit Sweden is holding a competition to "give away" five small Swedish islands for one year. The five winners will receive a certificate and the right to use their island for a year in their own way, which could involve boating, camping, inviting guests and enjoying lots of peace and quiet. Sweden has 267,570 islands – more than any other country in the world.



China Dancing robots on display

Dancing robots dazzled viewers during a Chinese New Year gala on television. Around 677 million people watched the show. The robots spun, jumped, backflipped and even performed kung fu martial arts moves alongside real children. The performance was created to show the world how advanced China's technology is.



Dancing robots.



South Korea Former president jailed for life

Former president Yoon Suk Yeol has been given a life sentence for leading an attempt to take over the government. In December 2024, he shocked the country by declaring martial law, which is when the military takes control of a country. Yeol claimed it was to protect the nation, but a judge said his actions harmed the country.



Yoon Suk Yeol



Nonthaburi, Thailand Police officers try clever disguise

Thai police caught a man accused of stealing religious objects worth £47,500 by disguising themselves as a dancing lion. The lion dance was part of celebrations for the Lunar New Year at a temple in Nonthaburi. Police used the costume as a disguise to get gradually closer to the suspect before jumping out and arresting him.



A lion dance in Bangkok.



Assisi, Italy Remains go on display

On 22 February, the bones of St Francis of Assisi went on public display for only the second time in 800 years. St Francis, who gave up his wealth and devoted his life to the poor, is one of the Christian religion's best-known saints. This year marks 800 years since his death. His skeleton is on display in a glass case until 22 March at a basilica (large church) in the town of Assisi, where St Francis was born.



The bones of St Francis.



The big debate

Are audiobooks as good as reading?

Some people say that reading really focuses your attention.

What you need to know

- An audiobook is a recording of a book being read out loud, usually by the author or an actor. You can download and listen to it wherever you like.
- Audiobooks are becoming much more popular. In 2024, the sales of audiobooks grew by 31%, while sales of printed books grew by just 2%.
- The National Literacy Trust, a charity that aims to improve reading and writing, found that more than a third of children and young people said listening to audiobooks made them want to read more. More than half said it helped them feel calmer when they were stressed.

Audiobooks are popular.



TELLING TALES

Many ancient myths and legends were told out loud for centuries, before anyone wrote them down.

Do you love curling up in a quiet corner with a book or do you prefer listening to a story? Many studies have shown that reading is good for you. It teaches you empathy (being able to understand and experience other people's feelings and points of view). It also teaches you new words and boosts your imagination. Studies have shown that reading helps people feel happier, healthier and even live longer. Some people think listening to an audiobook is only a step towards the real thing, which is reading from a book in your hand. Others point out that people have told stories out loud for thousands of years, long before books were invented, so listening to a story is just as good as reading one. What do you think? Is listening to an audiobook as good as reading?

Yes – you can listen anywhere

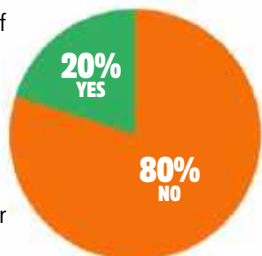
Audiobooks are a great way to enjoy stories and learn about sports, science or even history, especially if you find reading hard or don't like sitting still for long. Even better, you can listen almost anywhere, like on long car or train journeys, while tidying your room or relaxing on the sofa. You can also enjoy an audiobook with your friends or family instead of listening alone. All of this makes it easier to fit more reading time into your day. Another benefit of audiobooks is that when an actor reads the story, they use different voices to show the characters' feelings more clearly, which helps bring the story to life. Studies also show that hearing complex texts, like Shakespeare plays, out loud makes them easier to understand.

No – you're not paying proper attention

Some people say listening to audiobooks instead of reading is like cheating because you're not focusing in the same way. If you're listening while doing something else, then you can't always pay full attention. Experts say that when you read, your eyes often go back to check the words, which can help you understand better what you're reading. Turning the page also gives your brain tiny breaks that can help you to remember what you've read. This can't happen when you're listening to an audiobook. What's more, when someone else reads a story, you're hearing the way they want the characters to sound. When you read it yourself, you're using your own inner voice, which makes it much more personal.

LAST WEEK'S POLL

Last week, we asked if it's ok to scroll on a screen while you watch TV or a movie. Most of you feel it's important to pay attention and put your device away.



"Yes, it's ok because there are boring bits in a film that you might not want to watch."

"No, watching a film or a TV show with friends and family should be a nice way to connect."

YES Three reasons why audiobooks are as good as reading

- 1 Audiobooks help you enjoy stories and learn new things, especially if you find reading hard.
- 2 You can listen almost anywhere, like on long journeys or while tidying your room, and share the story with other people.
- 3 Actors use different voices to show emotions. This makes characters feel real and helps trickier stories like Shakespeare plays make more sense.

NO Three reasons why audiobooks are not as good as reading

- 1 If you're doing other things while you're listening to an audiobook, you might not focus properly on the story.
- 2 Experts say when you read, your eyes look back at words, which can help you understand what you're reading. You can't do that listening to an audiobook.
- 3 Hearing someone else's voice shows their version of the story, but reading uses your own inner voice, which makes it more personal.



WHAT DO YOU THINK?

Tell us what you think by voting in our poll. Go to theweekjunior.co.uk/polls or scan the QR code. Vote YES if you think audiobooks are as good as reading, or NO if you don't. We'll publish the results next week.





Helping children work for change

Patricia Parker's charity has inspired young people.

On 8 March, a charity called Kids for Kids will be marking its 25th anniversary. It was set up by Patricia Parker to improve the lives of children living in Darfur, Sudan. Parker, who is 78, is now stepping down as head of the charity. She told *The Week Junior* that no one is too young, or too old, to make a change.

Parker started Kids for Kids in 2001 after a trip to Darfur. She met a nine-year-old boy called Ibrahim who was on a seven-hour walk to get water for his family. After she met his mother and realised the tough conditions that children in their village were living in, Parker wanted to help. Since then, the charity has supported more than 600,000 people

in more than 100 villages by installing water pumps, providing goats to families so they have access to milk, and setting up kindergartens where children can get an education. Today, Ibrahim works as a farmer and has four children of his own. Parker

says his story illustrates the importance of what Kids for Kids does.

When she started the charity, Parker knew she was helping children in Sudan but she never considered her work would have an impact on children elsewhere. Lots of children around the world have found ways to help the charity, including children giving away their tooth fairy money. She says, "Children can make a real difference."



Children in Sudan.



Patricia Parker

VAST COUNTRY
Sudan is the third largest country in Africa, and the region of Darfur is the size of Spain.



Nagi with her award.

A teacher on a mission

A teacher has been given an award for promoting learning and helping children in India get an education. Rouble Nagi won the Global Teacher Prize and £740,000 in prize money for the work she does through her Rouble Nagi Art Foundation. It has set up more than 800 learning centres for children who have never been to school before. Her organisation also paints colourful artwork on the walls of poor city communities, celebrating topics like science and the environment, to encourage more people to want to learn. "Learning can happen anywhere. You just have to make it interesting," Nagi told the BBC.

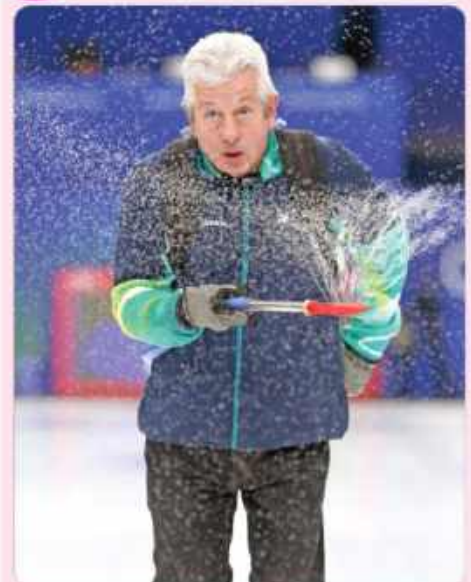
Electronic Eurovision act

Already a star on YouTube, electronic music artist Look Mum No Computer has been announced as the UK's entry for this year's Eurovision Song Contest. The 37-year-old musician, whose real name is Sam Battle, was the lead singer of a band called Zibra before going solo. He now has 1.4 million followers on social media and is known for building unusual electronic instruments, including organs made from Furby toys and one that shoots out flames. "I will be bringing every ounce of my creativity to my performances and I can't wait for everyone to hear and see what we've created," he said.



The UK's entry for Eurovision.

“99” THEY SAID IT!



“If it puts a smile on people's faces, then I'm fine with that.”

Mark Callan from Scotland worked at the Winter Olympics this year "pebbling" the curling rink (curling is a sport played on ice). This meant he shuffled backwards on the ice, sprinkling it with water to make it perfect for play. Callan's smooth moves made him popular on social media.



Animals and the environment



SCALE UP
Baby pangolins, known as pangopups, are born with soft scales that harden after a few days.

Sunda pangolins are hunted for their meat and scales.

Clever camera traps

Camera traps automatically take pictures and videos of wildlife without a human needing to be there. They are ideal for watching wildlife because animals are often scared off by people. Camera traps have sensors that detect movement and heat. When they sense something in front of them that is warm or moving, they snap a picture. The cameras can run on batteries for weeks or even months, storing all the photos they take. However, they have sometimes been damaged by the wildlife they are trying to photograph.



A scientist fits a camera trap to a tree.

Rare animals filmed in “Asia’s Amazon”

The conservation charity Fauna & Flora has recently revealed the results of its 2025 study of Asia’s Annamite mountain range. Scientists set up a network of cameras deep in the jungle in order to study the rare animals that live there.

The tree-covered Annamites stretch 700 miles through the countries of Laos, Vietnam and Cambodia in Southeast Asia. The mountains are often called the Amazon of Asia because – like the Amazon in South America – there is a huge variety of species living there. These include animals that are found nowhere else in the world. Lots of them are at risk of extinction, because of people hunting them

and destroying their habitat by cutting down trees.

Researchers from Fauna & Flora hid about 300 camera traps (see panel) in different areas of the mountains. They chose places where creatures would be likely to turn up, such as water sources and pathways that animals use to travel about.



The rare striped rabbit on the camera trap.

The cameras spotted a baby Sunda pangolin riding on its mother’s tail and two sun bears play-fighting. They also filmed a gaur, which is the largest species of wild cattle, a marbled cat, which uses its bushy tail to climb trees, and great hornbill birds, which spread plants’ seeds.

One of the rarest species spotted by the cameras was the Annamite striped rabbit. This species was unknown to scientists until 1996 and has only been photographed a few times in the wild. Another camera picked up a serow, which has been described as a cross between a goat and an antelope, with a mane, a beard and two short horns.

Gareth Goldthorpe, a researcher with Fauna & Flora, said the Annamites are “alive with a host of incredible creatures, each playing a critical role in maintaining the forest ecosystems that are vital to the health of our planet.”

The study will help scientists learn more about the species living there, such as their typical behaviour and their favourite places. This will help scientists work out how best to protect the wildlife.



NATURE SPY

Find hairy and sticky cleavers shooting up

Also called goosegrass, sticky bobs or sticky willy, cleavers are a plant found all over the UK. By this time of year, the plants start to shoot up in hedgerows, along the side of paths and roads, and in other wild spots. Best known as a fun plant you can stick onto people’s backs, cleavers are in the same family as the coffee plant and can be cooked and eaten like a vegetable when the plant is young (don’t try this without asking an adult first). The

plant’s stickiness comes from the many tiny hooks covering its hairy-looking stem, which it uses to climb by sticking to anything nearby. Its fruits also have sticky hooks, just like Velcro, which help them attach to people and animals and spread their seeds far and wide. The leaves are small, thin and hairy and they grow in circles from the stem. Tiny white flowers with four petals appear on cleavers later in spring or early summer.



Cleavers pop up on paths.



BETTER TOGETHER

Baboons live in groups called "troops", ranging in size from five animals to more than 200.



Chacma baboons in South Africa.

Baboons compete with their siblings

If you have a brother or sister, you might think they get too much attention sometimes. It turns out that baboons feel the same. A new study has found that young baboons compete with their siblings for time with their mothers. This shows that jealousy is not just a human emotion.

A team of scientists watching families of wild chacma baboons in Namibia, Africa, noticed that young baboons often interrupted their mothers when they were grooming another child, usually a younger brother or sister. Grooming – when an animal removes bugs and dirt from another's fur – is a sign of affection, just like a hug is for humans.

The scientists saw baboon children trying to get their mother's attention. They did this by biting, slapping, pushing, crying or luring their sibling away by pretending to

want to play. Mothers groomed some of their children more than others, and siblings interrupted these "favourites" more often. Overall, the young baboons' behaviour "strikingly mirrors patterns of sibling jealousy reported in humans," the study says.

The scientists said if the youngsters were trying to win attention, it didn't work very well. The baboons stopped their mums grooming another child about 20% of the time but the mothers only groomed them instead about 9% of the time. It was also found that as baboons grow older, they are less likely to display jealousy. It looks as if they grow out of it.

The study's lead author, Axelle Delaunay, a scientist at the University of Turku in Finland, hopes that other scientists will study primates in this way to find out more about how emotions affect their bodies, minds and behaviour.



Baby chacma baboons.



GOOD WEEK



Braun's wrasse

A tiny, rare fish called Braun's wrasse has been spotted for only the second time since its discovery in 1996. Researchers saw the colourful creature, which was last seen in 2009, while checking on kelp (seaweed) off the coast of Western Australia. "It took me a few seconds to register what I was seeing," said Océane Attlan, one of the researchers. The sighting is a relief to scientists, who were worried that warmer weather had caused the species to go extinct.

BAD WEEK



Gentoo penguins

Gentoo penguins are the first birds on Australian territory to test positive for a dangerous type of bird flu that can spread quickly. The virus, called H5N1, was first detected in southern elephant seals on Heard Island last year. Scientists are concerned that if the disease keeps spreading between species, it could threaten other birds. These include types of cormorant and sheathbill that aren't found anywhere else on Earth.

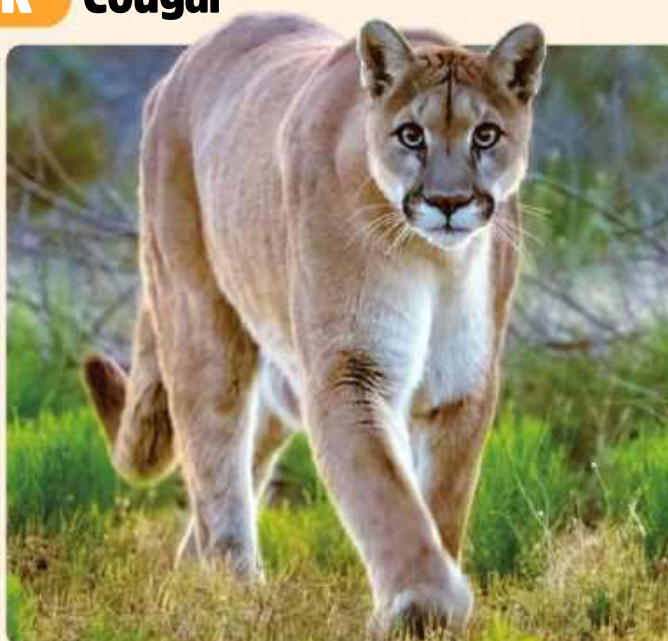


ANIMAL OF THE WEEK

Cougar

The US state of California has voted to list six groups of cougars under its Endangered Species Act. This means that government organisations must now protect the animals and their habitats by law.

- **LIFESPAN:** Around 14–16 years.
- **HABITAT:** Forests, prairies, deserts and swamps, from Canada in the north to Argentina in the south.
- **SIZE:** Up to 2.5 metres long and weighing around 60 kilograms.
- **DIET:** Includes moose, pigs, rodents.
- **FUN FACT:** Also called mountain lions, panthers and pumas, cougars can leap up to 12 metres.





All about WWF

Protecting nature across the world

How newspaper articles inspired the start of a global charity.

This year marks 65 years since the World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF) was founded to protect wildlife across the globe. In 1961, the conservation organisation set up offices in the UK, Switzerland and US. Today, it has offices in nearly 100 countries.

How did it start?

The idea for WWF came from a businessman called Victor Stolan. In 1960, Stolan read a series of newspaper stories about how wildlife in East Africa had been hunted almost to extinction – and he wanted to do something about it. He shared his idea with Max Nicholson, who was in charge of a UK Government department concerned with protecting nature, and WWF was born. The panda logo was drawn by another founder, Sir Peter Scott, who said, “We wanted an animal that is beautiful, endangered and loved by many people”. Having a black and white panda as the logo also made it cheap to print – colour printing was much more expensive at the time.

What is WWF's mission?

WWF's mission is to stop the destruction of nature and help it recover. As part of that, WWF aims to reduce pollution, fight climate change, inspire people to take action and show how humans can live in harmony with wildlife. In 1986 WWF changed its name from “World Wildlife Fund” to the “World Wide Fund for Nature”, although it kept the initials WWF. This was because its projects were expanding, and rather than focusing on individual endangered species, it wanted to restore large habitats and the variety of species on Earth. WWF still helps animals directly but it focuses on “priority species” – ones that support the survival of other species or entire ecosystems (communities of living things). An example of this is whales, which capture carbon dioxide (a harmful gas), stopping it from entering the atmosphere and causing climate change.

Gorillas

These apes maintain healthy forests. WWF helps them by developing gorilla tourism, so local people benefit from thriving gorillas.



Tigers

To protect one tiger, WWF has to conserve huge areas of forest. Since 2010, its work has helped increase tiger populations by about 74%.



ROLE MODELS
Sir David Attenborough and Steve Backshall are ambassadors for WWF.

A WWF scientist tracking animals.



Important habitats WWF helps to protect

The Arctic

This frozen region is threatened by global warming and human activity, such as fishing and mining for things like oil and gas. Climate change is causing the ice to melt and threatening wildlife that lives there. This includes Arctic foxes, polar bears, seals and whales.



The Congo Basin

Spanning six countries in central Africa, this region is home to 400 species of mammals, 1,000 types of bird and 10,000 tropical plant species. Endangered species include forest elephants and gorillas. It is under threat from humans cutting down trees and hunting wildlife.



he planet



FAMOUS FACE

The first WWF logo was based on a giant panda called Chi-Chi, who lived at London Zoo.

Turtles

By eating other species, turtles keep marine ecosystems healthy. WWF works to prevent fishing methods that harm turtles and habitats.



Pandas

Protecting pandas also helps species like the golden monkey. WWF has planted bamboo forests in panda habitats across China.



Local people in Peru's rainforest.

How does it help humans and wildlife?

WWF works with local people to help them look after their environment in a way that helps humans too. Dalla Village in Nepal is near a national park and wildlife sanctuary, home to important wildlife, including elephants and rhinos, but the animals can damage people's food crops. WWF supports locals in Dalla to offer tourists a place to stay in their homes. The scheme ensures that local people benefit from wildlife by earning money.

Science and technology helps WWF identify threats to wildlife. It has scientists across the world, and partners with local communities and other organisations. For example, WWF is working with a research organisation called British Antarctic Survey (BAS) to study emperor penguins. They use satellite images taken from space to track and monitor penguins on the remote continent. In Kenya, WWF is using technology such as thermal cameras (ones that sense heat from living things to create images) to help rhinos. It helps them to stop and catch people who are illegally hunting the animals in the dark.

How to help WWF

WWF has a club for children called Go Wild! Ask an adult to help you find it online at wwf.org.uk/gowild. It has lots of activities, quizzes and games designed to help children learn about wildlife. Every year in March, WWF organises Earth Hour. This year it will be held on 28 March. At 8.30pm, millions of people across the world will turn off their lights to show they care about the planet – even famous landmarks like Big Ben in London will switch off. There are lots of other ways to help WWF, such as fundraising for it or writing to your local Member of Parliament to raise awareness of a conservation issue you care about.



Eastern Himalayas

Covering Nepal, Bhutan and part of India, this region includes eight of the world's 10 highest mountains. It's home to the rare snow leopard and greater one-horned rhino, and is threatened by climate change and habitat loss.



A WWF researcher.



PLASTIC PROBLEM

Each year, around 20 million tonnes of plastic waste gets into the world's rivers, lakes and oceans.



Trusses support the floors.

Old plastic used for new houses

Researchers from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) in America have found a way to make parts of houses from recycled plastic.

The frameworks of houses, called skeleton frames, are usually made out of wood, steel or concrete, and they have to be very strong to keep the whole structure standing.

"We've estimated that the world needs about one billion new homes by 2050," said engineer and inventor AJ Perez, who led MIT's project. "If we try to make that many homes using wood, we would need to cut the equivalent of the Amazon rainforest three times over." Also, making steel and concrete can be bad for the environment.

Instead, MIT engineers have discovered that recycled plastic combined with bits of glass is strong enough to be used for these skeleton frames.

To create the plastic house frames, researchers used a process called 3D printing (see panel). They wanted to make the supports that sit under floors. These supports, which are called floor trusses, look like ladders with a zigzag inside instead

of bars. They make sure that the floor can carry the weight of everything that goes on it.

The team used a giant 3D printer, which takes up an entire room, to create four long trusses that are each taller than a doorway. Each of the trusses only weighs about six kilograms, which is lighter than the wooden versions, and it took less than 13 minutes to print each one. The researchers then put the trusses into a model of a floor and tested how much weight the trusses could take. They were able to support more than 1,800 kilograms, which is about as heavy as a car. That is officially strong enough to be used as a truss in a house.

Using plastic in houses could help to reduce plastic waste and stop it from polluting rivers and seas.

Plastic takes a long time to break down in nature. For example, polyethylene terephthalate (PET), which is used in plastic drink bottles, takes hundreds of years to break down.

The researchers hope that one day they can 3D print all the bits of a house's skeleton frame, so that used plastic could be turned into something useful on a really big scale.



The 3D printer making a truss.

The wonders of 3D printing

Three-dimensional (3D) printing uses a special machine that allows people to build objects, one layer at a time. Here are some cool things 3D printing can be used for.

- **Trainers** Adidas has 3D printed shoes that could help the wearer run faster.
- **Aeroplanes** Pieces of cargo doors and fuel nozzles have been 3D printed.
- **Body implants** Doctors have 3D printed metal implants that are put into people's bodies to replace bits of bone or teeth.
- **Human organs** Scientists want to 3D print human organs for people whose body parts aren't working properly.



3D printed trainers.



Study solves puzzle of ancient arrivals

Scientists have discovered where a mysterious group of people who arrived in Britain around 2400BC came from. Their culture was linked to the Beaker People – an ancient group from western Europe known for making bell-shaped pottery. Within about 100 years, they had almost completely taken over from Britain's earlier inhabitants, who built Stonehenge.

The discovery was made by scientists at Harvard University, in the US. They studied the genomes of 112 people who lived in mainland Europe between 8500BC and 1700BC. A genome is a complete set of DNA (a chemical that carries all the information about a living thing). Everyone's genome is slightly different. Scientists can extract

DNA from ancient teeth and bones and that can give clues about ancient people and when different groups met or mixed with each other.

The study revealed that the people who took over Britain came across the North Sea from north-western Europe. They were the ancestors of "hunter-gatherers" who lived in wet, boggy areas and survived on fish, birds and plants. DNA shows these hunter-gatherers lived this way long after farmers arrived. These people nearly – or maybe even completely – took over from Britain's Neolithic (New Stone Age) people. Scientists still don't know why the earlier people vanished but it's possible that a deadly disease appeared and wiped them out.



Beaker pottery from 2900-1800BC.



Bronze Age people.

LOST AND FOUND
Britain's biggest Bronze Age treasure hoard had more than 6,500 objects packed into a huge jar.



Robots are delivering food.

Robots take over takeaways

Imagine waiting for a takeaway and finding a robot at your door. This is now an option for customers in Bristol and Milton Keynes, in England, where Just Eat UK has started testing robot deliveries from nine local restaurants.

It works just like other deliveries – except that when someone orders food they can choose to have it brought by a person or a four-legged robot with wheels. The restaurant cooks the meal, places it inside the robot's storage box, scans the customer's address and sends it on its way.

The robots, which are already being used in Switzerland, can walk up steps, cross bumpy ground, open gates and avoid objects like bins and people. They have a top speed of 9.3 miles per hour and are fitted with trackers, alarms and cameras to keep them safe.

When a robot arrives, the customer unlocks the box using a smartphone app to collect their food. The first person to try the service from a fish and chip shop in Bristol, England, said that although their food was 10 minutes late they could see "this is the future".

FIND OUT MORE

If you're always curious, then the new issue of *Science+Nature* is just for you. Find out how every discovery starts with a question and why there's no such thing as a daft one.

OUT NOW!



Visit the world's strangest beasts



Find out if Bigfoot is running loose



Go nature-spotting this month

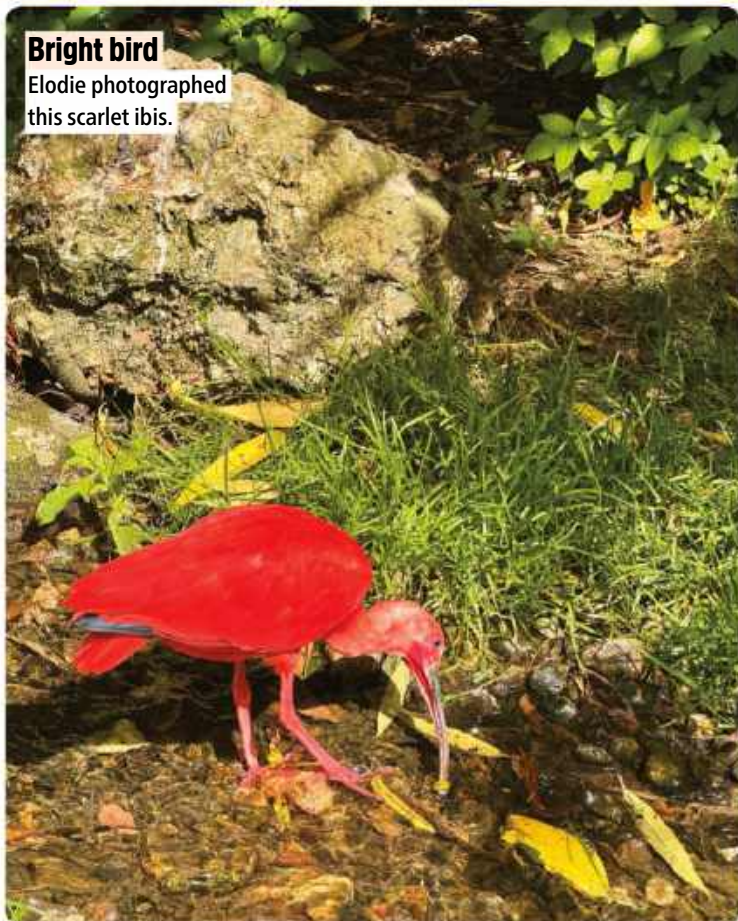
VISIT sciencenature.theweekjunior.co.uk



Photos of the week

Bright bird

Elodie photographed this scarlet ibis.



Whale-y cool

Immy saw this humpback whale in Nova Scotia, Canada.



In bloom

Arjun got close to these tulips at Keukenhof Gardens in the Netherlands.



Mountain marvels

Cloe captured this stunning scene while on holiday in China.

THE WEEK
Junior
Roving Reporter



SEND YOUR PHOTOS

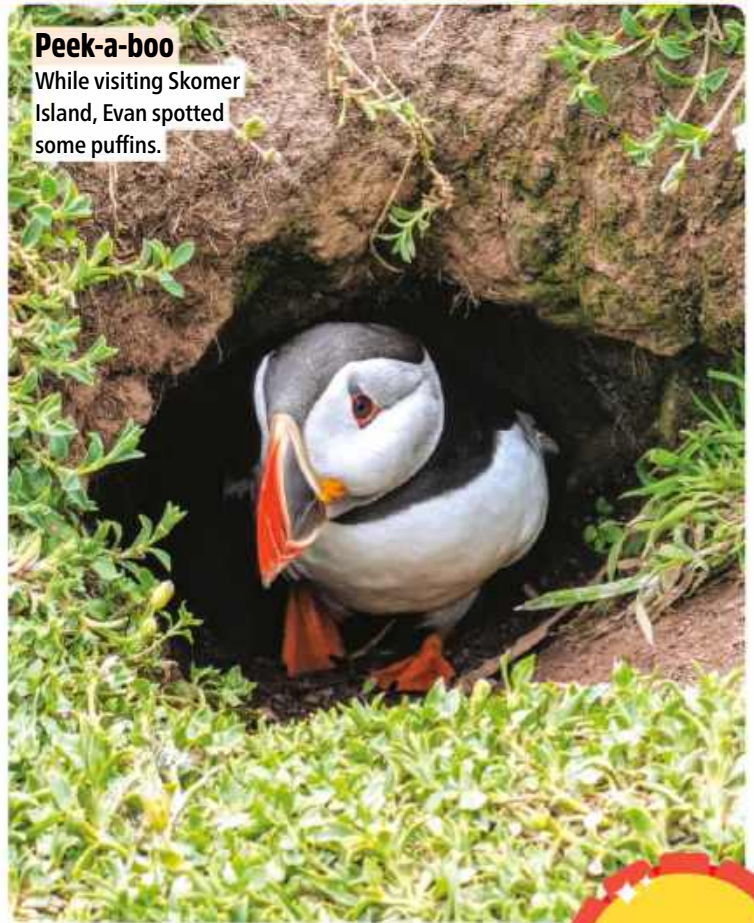
Email them to
hello@theweekjunior.co.uk

Photos of the week



Peek-a-boo

While visiting Skomer Island, Evan spotted some puffins.



Cuddle time

Edward saw some snuggling goslings in Sussex, England.



Snowy scene

Archie took this amazing picture of skiers in the Alps.



**YOUR
PHOTOS**

Once a month we feature photos by our readers. Ask a parent or carer to send in photos for you and make sure they read this: upon submitting images for publication, you the adult grant Future Publishing Ltd permission to publish the submission in the Week Junior publications and on their associated web and social pages.

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Sport



Johannes Hoesflot Klaebo



Sturla Holm Laegreid



Julia Simon



Arianna Fontana

GAME ON
The next Winter Olympics and Paralympic Winter Games will be in 2030, in the French Alps.

Paralympic Games



Neil Simpson (right) won gold.

The Paralympic Winter Games take place from 6 to 15 March. Around 665 para athletes (athletes with a disability or impairment) will compete in six sports: alpine skiing, biathlon, cross-country skiing, ice hockey, snowboard and wheelchair curling. Neil Simpson, who won a gold in skiing at the 2022 Paralympics, is part of Team GB again and hopes to repeat his victory.

Thrilling end to Winter Olympics

On 22 February, the exciting 2026 Winter Olympics came to an end. It began on 6 February and took place in Milan, Cortina d'Ampezzo and other areas in northern Italy. Britain won five medals, including three golds, equalling the most it had ever won at a Winter Olympics.

There were 16 sports at the Games, including ice hockey, speed skating, figure skating and bobsleigh. Around 2,900 athletes from 93 countries competed.

Norway topped the medal table, winning 18 golds, 12 silvers and 11 bronzes, a total of 41. Norway's Johannes Hoesflot Klaebo was the most successful athlete, winning six gold medals in cross-country skiing. He now holds the record for the most golds won at a single Winter Olympics. Sturla Holm Laegreid (Norway) won three silvers and two bronzes in men's biathlon (a race on cross-country skis before shooting a rifle at targets). France's Julia Simon was

the most successful woman biathlete, winning three golds and a silver.

The Italian short-track speed-skater Arianna Fontana gave fans lots to cheer – she won a gold and two silvers, taking her Winter Olympics career total to 14. She won her first medal in 2006, aged 15.

Britain won three gold medals for the first time. Matt Weston won the men's individual skeleton and the mixed team skeleton with Tabitha Stoeker. Team GB also won the mixed snowboard cross with Charlotte Bankes and Huw Nightingale. The other medals came in men's curling (silver) and with Zoe Atkin's bronze in women's halfpipe freestyle skiing.



Matt Weston won in skeleton.



THE WEEK'S WINNERS...

Loughborough Lightning
They defeated London Pulse 18-17 in the Netball Super Cup final in Sheffield. Pulse were last year's winners.

James Milner
Footballer Milner helped his team Brighton beat Brentford 2-0. It was his 654th Premier League appearance, which is more than any other player.



Keely Hodgkinson
The British athlete won the women's 800 metres title at an indoor event in Liéven, France. She set a world record of 1 minute 54.87 seconds.

Laura Muir
Running at the Scottish cross-country championships, Muir won the women's 10-kilometre race. She finished 13 seconds ahead of the runner-up.

Find sparks of joy

Spotting things that boost your happiness is good for your body and brain.

Happy facts



Did you know that sea otters hold hands when they sleep, or that a group of pugs is called a grumble? Author Emily Coxhead wrote a whole book of happy facts like these, called *Happy Days: 365 Facts to Brighten Every Day of the Year* – winner of The Week Junior's Children's Choice award. She says, "The idea is to simply bring a little joy to each day, open up conversations and give children (and adults!) something to look forward to."

Emily Coxhead's three steps to joy



- **Do one thing everyday that makes you happy.** Like reading, making crafts or cuddling your pet.
- **Be kind.** Kindness spreads, so when you make someone smile they might pass the feeling on to someone else.
- **Get some fresh air.** It sounds simple, but being outside really does boost your mood. Even a little sunshine can make you feel brighter and more positive.

Enjoy little things like dancing with a friend.

HAPPY HOPPERS

Quokkas are known as the world's happiest animal because they always look like they're smiling.

Do you remember the last thing that made you smile? Finding sparks of joy brightens your day and gives you the power to overcome challenges.

What are sparks of joy?

These are little things that make you smile and feel good inside. They could include listening to your favourite song or sharing a silly joke with a friend. Even when something amazing happens, like winning a prize, the excitement doesn't last forever. Studies show this is because everyone has a set level of happiness they usually return to after something good or bad happens. Finding sparks of joy can top up your mood. Author and happiness expert Pam Garramone says these sparks are everywhere if you look for them. "Focus on what's good, what makes us smile," she says.

Is it good for you?

Being happy is good for your body and brain. When you feel happy you have more energy, which makes you want to

move around, and this lifts your mood even more. Scientists say happiness can lower stress and boost your immune system, which helps you fight illnesses. Even small sparks of joy can make a big difference because they train your brain to notice happy moments. Author Emily Coxhead explains that "not only does it positively impact our every day and the people around us, it also helps us deal with not so great things in our lives too, making us more resilient."

Where do you find joy?

No-one is happy all the time but if you know where to find sparks of joy you can give yourself a boost when you need it, Garramone says. Make a go-to list of things that make you happy, like snuggling up on the sofa and watching a film. Make a happy jar:

Do things that make you smile.

whenever something makes you smile, write it on some paper and put it in the jar. After a few days you'll see there are lots of things that boost your mood. Getting plenty of sleep makes it easier for your brain to hold on to good memories, so wind down before bedtime by switching off screens and reading or drawing instead.





BEWARE OF THE DOG

In 1962, the National Gallery hired a guard dog called Rex to protect its paintings from thieves.



The Art on Your Doorstep exhibition.

The National Gallery



It has been more than 200 years since the National Gallery (above) first opened to the public in 1824. At first it was based in a regular house but it was moved to Trafalgar Square, London, in 1838. The gallery's collection of more than 2,600 artworks includes paintings by famous artists including Vincent van Gogh, Claude Monet and Leonardo da Vinci.

Bringing art to your doorstep

The National Gallery's new exhibition takes art into communities around the UK.

The National Gallery in London is home to more than 2,600 artworks – from the 13th to the 20th centuries. A new exhibition called *Art on Your Doorstep* is taking life-sized versions of some of these paintings to communities around the UK.

The free outdoor exhibition is now running in Croydon, London. It will also visit Torquay, England, and Londonderry (Derry), Northern Ireland, next month. It will also be at Brentford and Kirklees, in England, and Newport, Isle of Wight, later this year.



Rachel Gadsden

In each location, the local community has helped choose the paintings to be displayed. Croydon's exhibition features 30 paintings. Caterina

Loriggio, who works on cultural events in Croydon, told *The Week Junior* that they ran workshops with residents to choose the artworks. The workshops asked questions such as "Which painting reminds you of Croydon?", and residents chose from different paintings for their answer. Loriggio said, "What was interesting was how many people chose the same things."

The National Gallery's Hannah Widginton said that Croydon selected lots of paintings of women for the exhibition, which she said no one else has done. They've called it the "wall of ladies".

Loriggio suggests that people should see the paintings as the seasons change, because they'll look different. *Whistlejacket* (see below) is near a tree that will blossom in spring, which she said will make it look "really beautiful".

Artist Rachel Gadsden has also been working with people in Croydon, including children, to create an artwork celebrating the area – to be revealed in May. *Art on Your Doorstep* is in Croydon until 5 July.

Three artworks you can see in Croydon

Whistlejacket

This was painted by George Stubbs around 1762, and is a life-sized portrait of a prizewinning racehorse. The horse belonged to Charles Watson-Wentworth, who paid Stubbs to paint it. The artwork is huge – it's nearly three metres tall.



Surprised!

Henri Rousseau's 1891 painting was the first of around 20 artworks in his "jungle" collection. The jungles in his paintings were completely imaginary because Rousseau never left France. He initially picked up painting as a hobby and was entirely self-taught.



Self Portrait in a Straw Hat

In 1782, Elisabeth Louise Vigée Le Brun painted this portrait of herself. When she was growing up, women weren't allowed to get formal art training. She learned how to paint from her father and then taught herself, becoming a famous portrait painter.





★ ★ ENTERTAINMENT NEWS ★ ★



The judges and hosts of the new series.

WATCH OUT
Three million people saw the first episode of the new series of Britain's Got Talent.

BGT returns with new judge

The popular television show *Britain's Got Talent* (BGT) returned to ITV1 on 21 February with a new judge for the 19th series. Musician and YouTuber KSI was welcomed to the judges' panel, after appearing as a guest judge last year.

KSI took his seat next to three other judges who are familiar faces to fans of the show: music businessman Simon Cowell, actress and presenter



Winner Harry Moulding.

Amanda Holden, and singer Alesha Dixon. Comedy duo Ant and Dec returned as hosts, a role they have held since BGT first started in 2007.

Last year, magician Harry Moulding was crowned the winner after performing a card trick that featured him skydiving out of a plane. He won a £250,000 cash prize and appeared at the famous Royal Variety Performance.



THIS WEEK'S WATCH LIST



Operation Ouch!

Available on CBBC and BBC iPlayer

How do muscles grow? What makes your stomach rumble? Why do you have snot? Twins Dr Chris and Dr Xand are back with another series of *Operation Ouch!* to answer all the silly and serious questions that you might have about human bodies.



Descendants/Zombies Worlds Collide: Concert Special

Available on Disney+

When performers from Disney's *Descendants* and *Zombies* movies and series went on tour together last year, they sold out shows across the US. Fans can watch the concert with guests including singer Rita Ora and actress Meg Donnelly, plus behind-the-scenes footage.



Rumble

Available on Netflix

The animated comedy movie about the friendship between a clumsy wrestling monster and his ambitious young coach has come to Netflix. This "zero to hero" story features the voices of actors and real wrestlers, including Will Arnett and Terry Crews.

FILM CLUB

The magical nanny is back for a new adventure.

Mary Poppins Returns

Disney+, Amazon Prime Video

The original *Mary Poppins* film has become a much-loved classic since it was first released in 1964. With *Mary Poppins Returns* (2018), the no-nonsense nanny is back, but this time Michael Banks – the young boy in the first film – has grown up and now he has three children of his own. To help them cope with a family tragedy, Mary Poppins, played by Emily Blunt, arrives and takes the children on a series of wild adventures filled with wacky characters, colourful dance scenes and new songs. The *Mary Poppins* movies are based on characters from books written by author P. L. Travers – and with World Book Day just around the corner, *Mary Poppins Returns* is perfect for a book-themed movie night.





Book club



5 £1 books for World Book Day

These are just some of the brilliant reads you can get for free with your book token.

Bunny Vs Monkey: Total Chaos



by *Jamie Smart*

(David Fickling Books)

Plunge into the hilarious world of *Bunny Vs Monkey* in this graphic novel, full to the brim with mayhem and mischief. Monkey is scheming to take over The Woods and only Bunny can stop him. To do that, though, he'll first need to find his thermal underwear and fire up the Flan Cannon.

Skandar and the Secret Element



by *A.F. Steadman*

(Simon & Schuster)

When Albert is whisked away to a mysterious island to bond with a powerful warrior unicorn, he meets a boy called Skandar, who is hiding a powerful secret. Even if you're new to A.F. Steadman's action-packed *Skandar* series, this makes a thrilling read for lovers of fantasy and edge-of-your seat adventure.

Chaos at the Chocolate Factory



by *Sibéal Pounder*

Illustrated by *Emily Jones*

(Puffin Books)

This new tale inspired by Roald Dahl's characters follows Charlie Bucket as he learns about running Willy Wonka's famous factory. There are lots of tasty new creations to be invented, but when the Oompa-Loompas need a holiday, there's trouble in store.

Bear Rescue



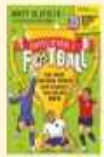
by *Hannah Gold*

Illustrated by *Levi Pinfold*

(HarperCollins)

August is the younger brother of April, the main character in *The Last Bear*. When an unexpected snowstorm strikes, August goes missing. Can April, Bear and Blaze the husky track him down and bring him safely home? This is a perfect pick for animal lovers.

Unbelievable Football: The Most Amazing World Cup Stories You Never Knew



by *Matt Oldfield*

Illustrated by *Ollie Mann*

(Hachette)

If you prefer facts to fiction, you'll enjoy this book about some of history's most unbelievable World Cup football moments. Read about memorable matches, glorious goal-scorers and penalty shoot-out dramas. It's an ideal book for sports fans.

BOOK OF THE WEEK

The Shadow Pony

by *Olivia Wakeford*

Illustrated by *David Litchfield*

(HarperCollins)

Pit ponies were small, strong ponies that were once put to work deep underground in mines to pull carts filled with coal. Eventually machines were developed to do the work but pit ponies were still working in Britain as recently as the 1990s. In this story, Evan's grandfather once worked in a coal mine – but he refuses to talk to Evan about what it was like, and about the poor pit ponies who worked down there in the dark. Evan wants to know more about Grandad's past: he feels that if he can discover the truth, then the strange distance between them might disappear. What is Grandad hiding? This heartfelt story touches on the important relationships between grandchildren and grandparents, and the bond between people and animals.



WIN! We're giving away five copies of *The Shadow Pony*

For a chance to win a copy, just fill in the entry form at theweekjunior.co.uk/book-giveaway before the closing date of 5 March at midday. Make sure you have a parent or guardian's permission to enter.* Congratulations to Eva, Esmé, Tim, Grace and Lyra & Seren, who each won a copy of *The Last Wolf* (issue 531).

ASK THE AUTHOR



Olivia Wakeford

The author talks about her dog and guesses how many books she's read.

What does family mean to you?

Family means having people by your side no matter what. It's people you choose, as well as those you are related to.

How many books do you think you have read in your lifetime?

Great question! I usually read at least 50 books a year, so it'll be in the thousands.

What is your favourite thing about Evan, your main character?

I love Evan's conviction and determination – even if it's sometimes misdirected!

What is the perfect writing spot?

In my study, with

a scented candle flickering, classical music playing and my dog curled up nearby, gently snoring and dreaming of cheese (probably).

Tell us about your dog.

My writing companion is a fox-red Labrador called Obi, who is a constant source of delight and inspiration.



READERS RECOMMEND

Name: **Bethany**



The Hunt for the Nightingale

by *Sarah Ann Jukes*

"Unputdownable, interesting and factual. I would recommend this book to anyone who wants to find out about birds!"

YOUR TURN

Please email your book review to hello@theweekjunior.co.uk. If it is printed in the magazine you will receive a Roving Reporter badge. Describe your chosen book in three words, tell us what you liked about it and why you would recommend it to others. Don't forget to include your name and address.*



DAVID LITCHFIELD, LUKA FREEMAN, SIMON AND SCHUSTER CO. UK
SUA.ORG.UK • JULIE BROADBENT • WORLDBOOKDAY.COM



Sharing the magic of reading with pupils

Julie Broadbent is an award-winning school librarian.

Last year, school librarian Julie Broadbent won the 2025 Secondary School Librarian of the Year award. Broadbent has worked at Northampton International Academy in England for three and a half years, and the School Library Association gave her the award for her work making reading a positive and celebrated experience for children.

Broadbent tells *The Week Junior* that being a librarian is the "best job ever" because she gets to help young people on their reading journey. When she joined the school, there hadn't been a librarian for more than a year, and neither of the school's libraries were working properly. Broadbent has transformed them.

One of the big changes has been the Reading Pioneers club, which has grown from three to around 30 members. The Reading Pioneers promote a love of reading throughout the school, but they also do local community work. Broadbent says the Reading Pioneers are "the most brilliant club we have at school".

She is looking forward to World Book Day, which is celebrated in the UK and Ireland on 5 March every year. The World Book Day charity celebrates the joy of reading for fun. Every year, children across the UK and Ireland receive a £1 book token they can swap for a World Book Day book or use towards another book of their choice. This helps millions of young people discover stories they might not otherwise have experienced.

Broadbent says the Reading Pioneers will be heading out to local primary schools to present assemblies that promote the magic of reading, and to share tips for less confident readers. The library is hosting quizzes and competitions, including a bookmark-designing contest, to give pupils the chance to win books of their own.

On top of that, the primary and secondary school staff will be dressing up as book characters on the day. Broadbent, who has been re-reading Julia Donaldson's books with her grandson, says she is dressing up as the witch from *Room on the Broom*.

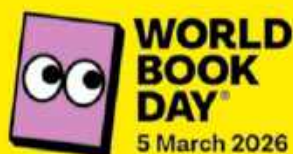


The Reading Pioneers.



TOP PICKS
The most popular books in Broadbent's school are from the Skandar, Lottie Brooks and Percy Jackson series.

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On screen



Hoverboard heaven

Mobile hit Subway Surfers is back in a new game exploring the city.

In the 2010s a new style of game took tablets and smartphones by storm: the endless runner. Viewed from behind your character, it involved running, jumping and dodging from side to side to avoid obstacles for as long as possible.

Temple Run, Minion Rush and Jetpack Joyride were three examples of endless-runner games played by millions of people, but one rival stood (and ran) well above the crowd: Subway Surfers.

Set in the underground network of a city, it involved collecting coins and power-ups while avoiding tube trains

and barriers – often with the help of pogo sticks and hoverboards to “surf” out of danger. It is still played by more than 100 million people every month.

Now there is a follow-up game, Subway Surfers City, for Android and Apple devices. It's set in four areas of the fictional (made-up) Subway City: The Docks, Southline, Sunrise Boulevard and DeLorean Park.

The game's “Classic Endless” mode is like the original Subway Surfers, where you run for as long as possible and, when you get stopped, start again.

However, it also has a “City Tour” mode, where you work your way through different levels and missions, as well as special events

that will happen regularly after the game's release on 26 February.

The game features new characters as well as some of the ones from the first game, and they have some great moves to help them through: “stomping” to reveal secrets, a shield made out of bouncy bubblegum and even drones that help you fly up high. Like Subway Surfers, the game's hoverboards and special moves are deliberately unrealistic and cartoonish to make it obvious that it's not encouraging people to copy it in the real world.

Also like the first game, Subway Surfers City is free to download but has optional in-app purchases. You should never feel pressured to spend money, and if you do want to, always check with an adult first.



Play in different parts of the city.



UPDATE OF THE WEEK

MOUNTS OF MAYHEM

If you haven't played Minecraft in a while, you may have missed its Mounts of Mayhem update. It has you riding different animals into battle, including under the ocean. Horses, camels and even pigs can help you get around faster.



PODCAST OF THE WEEK

EVERYTHING UNDER THE SUN

This weekly podcast has been taking a little break since Christmas, but there are more than 170 episodes to catch up on if you're new to it, including recent interviews with TV star Andy Day and space expert Jim Al-Khalili.



WEBSITE OF THE WEEK

FACTS ABOUT DOLPHINS

Did you know that there are 42 different species of dolphin? This and other facts can be found on the site of charity Whale and Dolphin Conservation, including the foods dolphins eat, how long they live, and how they are different from fish.



How to...



Make pretty Holi garlands

Celebrate spring by crafting these colourful strings of flowers.

Holi, known as the festival of colours, will be celebrated by Hindu communities around the world on 4 March. Hinduism is one of the world's oldest religions – it dates back more than 4,000 years. Holi celebrates the Hindu god Krishna and the arrival of spring. Friends and families splash or smear each other with colours: paint or dyed water. In Hinduism, flower garlands, called "mala" in India, are an important part of worship, celebrations and festivals, including Holi.

This activity shows you how to make a mala out of paper towels. One sheet of paper towel makes four 10cm-wide flowers and it takes around 30 flowers to fill a 50cm garland. You can make smaller or bigger flowers if you wish, and hang them in your bedroom.

What you need

- Paper kitchen towel
- Pen and pencil
- A bin liner or plastic bag
- Scissors
- Glue
- Paints
- Thin string or elastic
- Brush

TOP TIP

Gluing two or three flowers together makes a fuller shape and helps spread them out along the length of the string.

SPRING COLOURS

Dried flowers are often used to create colourful paints and dyes for Holi.

1 Place four sheets of paper towel on a bin liner. Use a large brush to paint over the paper in bright colours. Make the paint runny, so it spreads easily. Leave to dry.



2 Once the paper has dried, carefully peel it up off the plastic sheet and cut each piece into four squares. It might wrinkle up slightly, but don't worry.



3 Fold each square in half, then in half again (into quarters). Draw and cut a wavy curve from corner to corner – this will create petal shapes around the edge. Repeat this with all the squares.



4 Open up your flowers. On each one, dab a spot of glue at the edge of a petal and pinch it so it sticks to the next petal and gives the flower a cup-like shape. Push a pencil through the centre and thread onto the string.



Head to theweekjunior.co.uk/activityhub for more crafts and recipes.



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That's unbelievable!

Monkeying about with socks

An art student has secured herself a Guinness World Record by creating the world's largest sock monkey. Emilia Evans-Munton's mega creation was about 15 metres long, the length of three large cars parked end to end, and took two weeks to make. She used 60 metres of a fabric called corduroy stuffed with 40 bales of straw. The monkey's giant eyes were made from recycled wood. Evans-Munton, who studies at Glasgow School of Art in Scotland, said she got the idea when she found a sock monkey she had made when she was little.



Emilia Evans-Munton's giant sock monkey.

Retro tech gets cuddly new look

Crochet artist Nicole Nikolich has brought retro technology from the early 2000s back by stitching it out of yarn for a new exhibition. Retro technology refers to old-fashioned devices, such as mobile phones with buttons instead of a touch screen and Nintendo Game Boys. Nikolich's big colourful recreations were made by hand, and each gadget features thousands of individual stitches. They are on show at a gallery in Philadelphia, US. The artist said she wanted to make soft and cuddly versions of tech devices that she was fond of as a teenager.

A crochet Game Boy (below) and retro phones (right).



REMEMBER I'M STILL HERE BY EMILIA EVANS-MUNTON (2023) INSTALLATION
Glasgow School of Art, Glasgow
2023 ADRIAN STOKER NICOLE NIKOLICH PHOTOGRAPHY MEDIA



Image created to illustrate story.

Cat burglar caught at last

A mischievous feline spent more than a year stealing items of clothing from a school in Whakatāne, New Zealand, before being discovered. The kitty's crimewave peaked when the school's swimming pool was open – taking items such as underwear, goggles and towels, and often dropping them along a footpath to the school. The cat was finally rumbled when a staff member checked security camera footage. The school nicknamed the cat "Slinky Malinki", and the owners – who live next door to the school – apologised for their pet's behaviour.

Real OR rubbish?



Image created to illustrate story.

Snack machines with a twist

In Dushanbe, the capital of Tajikistan, vending machines that offer healthy snacks have been introduced – and they have a special built-in twist to encourage people to use them. Every so often, each machine rewards the user with a bar of real gold, which appears from a hidden panel behind the food and drops down into the collection slot. Ten of the machines have been installed in places such as shopping centres on a trial basis. However, only a lucky few will strike gold; the company that makes the machines says a bar is awarded to one in every 10,000 people, on average. Is this real, or an expensive lie?*

*Rubbish! The National Bank of Tajikistan is installing vending machines containing gold in Dushanbe but gold bars are the only thing they will contain – and people will have to pay for them.

Puzzles

Wordsearch

Can you find all of the flying things listed? They are hidden horizontally, vertically or diagonally and may read forwards or backwards.

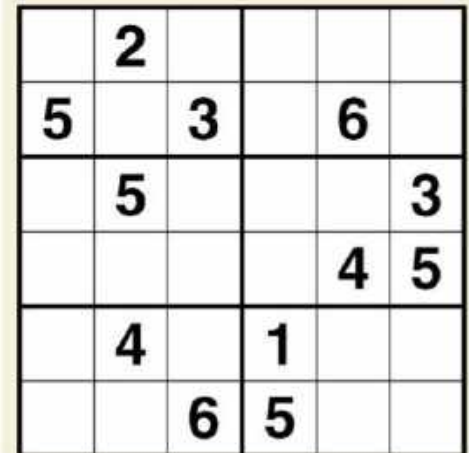
AEROPLANE
BALLOON
BAT
BEE
BIRD
BLIMP
BUTTERFLY
DRONE
FLAG
GLIDER
HELICOPTER
INSECT
JET
KITE
MICROLIGHT
MOTH
ROCKET
SPACESHIP
WASP
ZEPPELIN



ANSWERS
ARE ON
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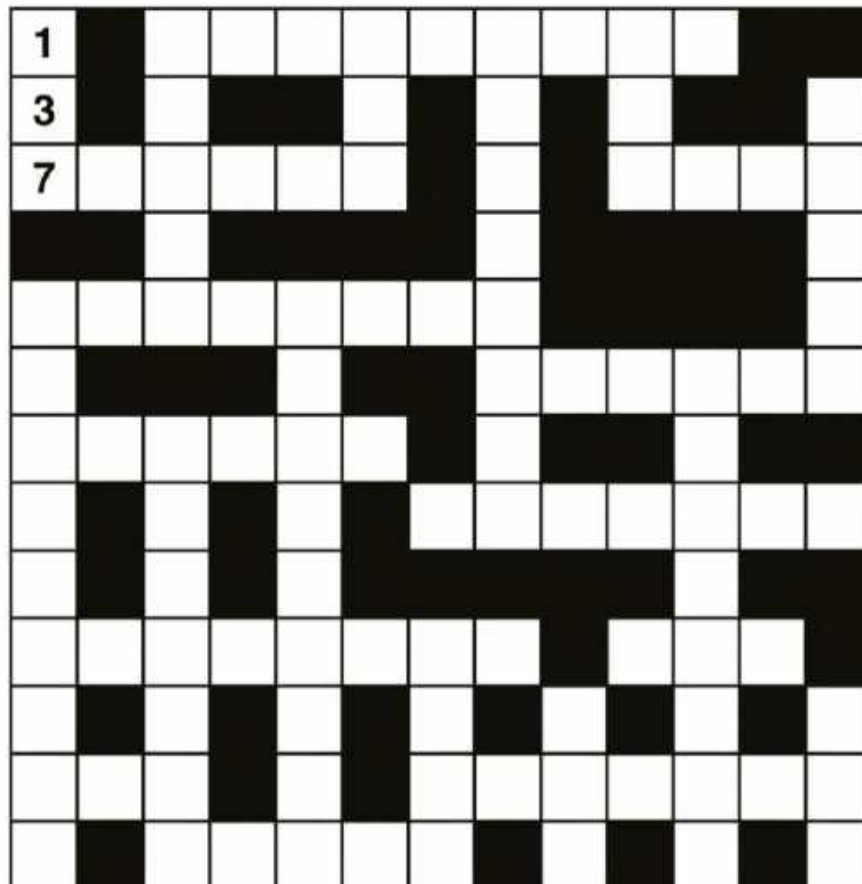
Sudoku

Place the numbers from 1 to 6 exactly once in each row, column and 2x3 bold-lined box, to complete the grid.



Number fit

All these numbers fit in the grid. Can you work out where they go? We've placed one to start you off.



3 numbers 137
393
401
661
681
718
938

6 numbers 232358
501877
761781

7 numbers 2837286
3055626
8096816

4 numbers 6884
24764167
8140
50274830

5 numbers 61640500
36132
81680387
64304
70247

9 numbers 338626776
465144183
512452291

Split words

For World Book Day, rearrange the groups of letters to find words from the *Treasure Island* adventure story.

BO Y NES BIL L

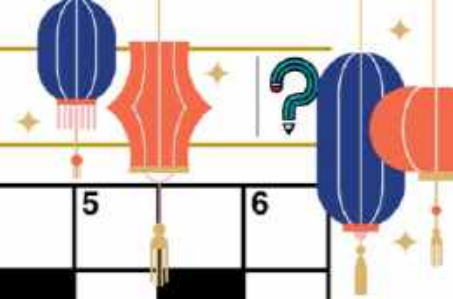
SPA HI IO LA N

K OG D BL AC

EL S ETON K



Puzzles



Crossword

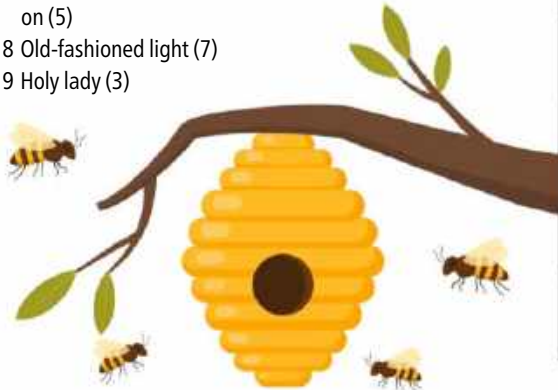
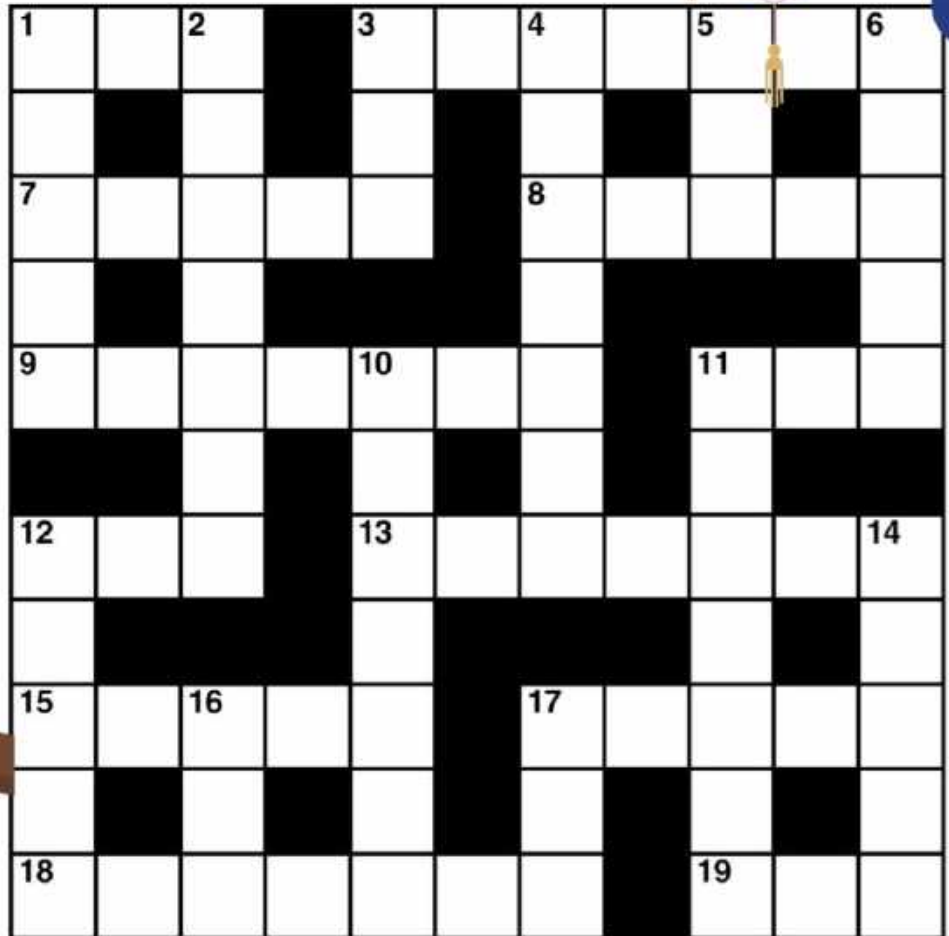
Read the clues carefully and write the answers into the grid.

Across

- 1 Fishing-pole (3)
- 3 Glass containers (7)
- 7 Facial hair growth (5)
- 8 Meeting point of straight lines (5)
- 9 Finger protector when sewing (7)
- 11 Baked pastry dish (3)
- 12 Human limb (3)
- 13 Single hair around the organ of sight (7)
- 15 Cute Disney deer (5)
- 17 Material for writing on (5)
- 18 Old-fashioned light (7)
- 19 Holy lady (3)

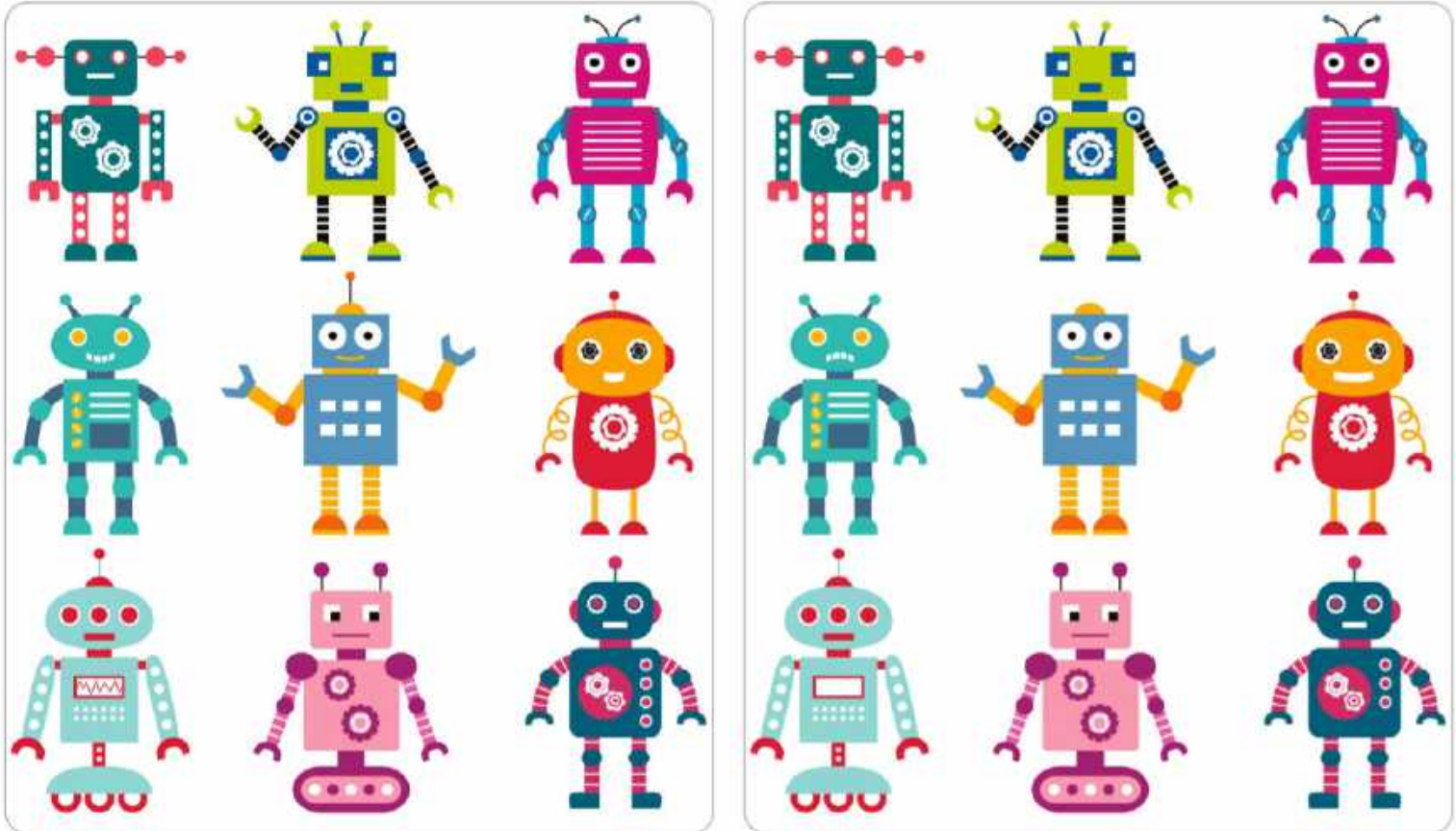
Down

- 1 Mechanical person (5)
- 2 Pencil sketch (7)
- 3 Unopened flower (3)
- 4 Circus swing (7)
- 5 Piece of wood (3)
- 6 Strainer (5)
- 10 Honey-makers' nest (7)
- 11 Baby's toy-filled enclosure (7)
- 12 Tag (5)
- 14 Fish-eating bird (5)
- 16 Adult boy (3)
- 17 Safety __, fastener (3)



Spot the difference

These two pictures appear to be the same, but take a closer look. There are actually five differences. Can you spot them?



REX SHUTTERSTOCK

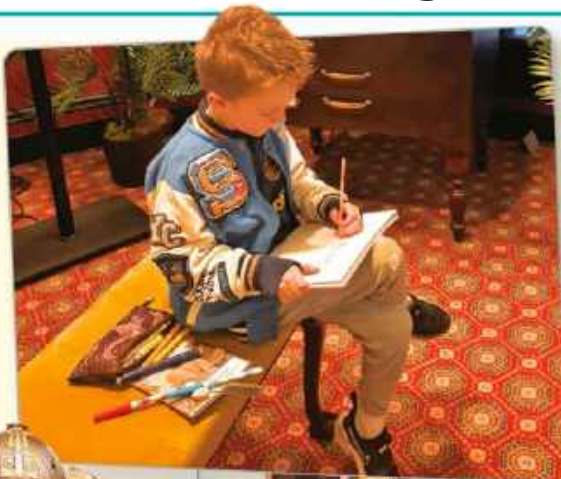


Over to you

My antics at the local museum

Name: **Sonny**

“On a rainy day me and my family went to our local museum, the Russell-Cotes Museum in Bournemouth, England. It used to be a Victorian house and the owners travelled around the world collecting different souvenirs and art from their travels. First we went into the art gallery and saw lots of big paintings but my favourite part was seeing the Japanese exhibition. I loved seeing the warrior costumes, samurai swords and fancy jewellery. I sat for about an hour with my mum and drew the swords in my sketch book. There was even a pianist playing the piano in the main hall! I want to go back and draw some more.”



TEACHER OF THE WEEK

Teacher's name:

Mr Edgar

School: **St Peter's Church of England Primary School, London, England**



“Mr Edgar is kind and he makes maths easy. At break time he plays football with us and that also means that I can talk to him. He is really nice in English lessons because he lets us watch educational videos to make it more fun. He is also really funny. Sometimes instead of saying ‘ladies and gentlemen’, he says ‘ladies and germs’, which makes me laugh. At home time, so that he knows which child is leaving, we give him a fist pump before we leave.” Leonora

If we pick your teacher as Teacher of the Week, we'll send your school three free issues of *The Week Junior*. Send your nominations, along with a picture of your teacher and your school's full name and address, to hello@theweekjunior.co.uk



JOKE OF THE WEEK

“What time do you go to the dentist?
Tooth-hurty!”
Izzy



CHARITY OF THE WEEK



Imagine

Imagine is the national organisation in Scotland for developing and celebrating theatre and dance for young people. Imagine organises the Edinburgh International Children's Festival, which presents theatre, circus and dance shows for children aged up to 15 years old, and attracts over 15,000 children, parents, teachers and artists. Ask an adult to find out more at imagine.org.uk

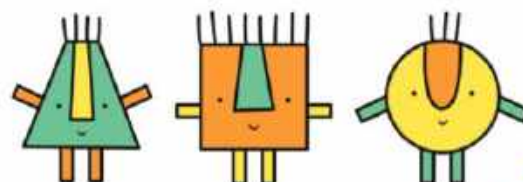


GET INVOLVED

Join the Global Kids Sewing Party

This March, thousands of children, schools and families around the world are sewing softies in the Global Kids Sewing Party. It's fun, creative and super simple. Anyone can make a difference to their community by giving their creations; all you need is a needle, thread, fabric and some stuffing and you're ready to go. If you're looking for inspiration or imaginative easy-to-sew softie ideas, there are lots of free sewing tutorials at the Sew a Softie website. To register, ask an adult to help you visit tinyurl.com/TWJ-Sew

Sew a Softie
Global Kids Sewing Party



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REGISTER NOW



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YOUR PHOTOS

We'd love to see your snaps. Send them to us at hello@theweekjunior.co.uk
Don't forget to tell us why you took them.



"This is a photo of me reading my copy of *The Week Junior* on a ski lift in the French Alps."

Harriet

"This is me at the Free Spanish Hounds march on 1 February in London. The peaceful protest was attended by 300 people and more than 100 dogs to raise awareness of animal rights for Spanish hunting dogs. I made a sign and walked with my two podencos, Cliff and Alice, who were adopted from Hope for Podencos."

Bert



"I made a colourful paper bird, to decorate my window. I love the way the light shines through the coloured paper."

Keera



"For the Winter Olympics I thought that birds could have as much fun as my family. So I made an apple bird feeder (issue 527) so they can have fun and stay safe in winter."

Thomas



Puzzles page and quiz answers



- Split words**
Skeletton.
Billy Bones, Hispaniola, Black Dog.
15 Corduroy
Day is on 5 March 13 True 14 b) Spring
11 False, it was called Rex 12 World Book
9 a) French Alps 10 The quokka
6 Pangopups 7 c) Panda 8 True
the winner 3 Sweden 4 c) Sudan 5 True
1 b) Orangutan 2 False, Zootropolis 2 was



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Quiz of the week

1 What sort of stuffed toy was given to Punch the monkey to keep him company at a zoo in Japan?

- ☐ a) Giraffe
☐ b) Orangutan
☐ c) Bear

2 True or false? *KPop Demon Hunters* won best animated film at this year's BAFTA awards.

- ☐ True ☐ False

3 Which country is "giving away" five of its islands for one year?

4 What is the third largest country in Africa?

- ☐ a) Kenya
☐ b) South Africa
☐ c) Sudan

5 True or false? Musician Sam Battle's stage name is Look Mum No Computer.

- ☐ True ☐ False

6 What are baby pangolins known as?

7 Which animal is used in the World Wide Fund for Nature's logo?

- ☐ a) Tiger
☐ b) Elephant
☐ c) Panda



8 True or false? Food delivery company Just Eat UK is testing out robot delivery services.

- ☐ True ☐ False

9 Where will the 2030 Winter Olympics take place?

- ☐ a) French Alps
☐ b) Andes
☐ c) Himalayas

10 Which species is known as the world's happiest animal?

11 True or false? In 1962, the National Gallery in London hired a guard dog called Rocky.

- ☐ True ☐ False

12 What date is World Book Day?

13 True or false? More than 100 million people play the Subway Surfers game every month.

- ☐ True ☐ False

14 The festival of Holi celebrates the arrival of which season?

- ☐ a) Winter
☐ b) Spring
☐ c) Summer

15 What type of fabric did an art student use to make the world's largest sock monkey?

ANSWERS
ARE ON
PAGE 33

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